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NATIONALLY, IT'S A BUYER'S MARKET. NOT IN CHICAGO.

Sellers outnumber buyers by 51 percent nationally. Chicago's gap is one tenth of that.

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EVERY SELLER CALL THIS MONTH OPENS WITH THE SAME HEADLINE. IT DOES NOT APPLY HERE.

Chicago's market is balanced, not buyer-favored, and the local numbers prove it.

4.9 PERCENT.

Nationally, sellers outnumbered buyers by 51.3 percent in July, nearly matching December's record 51.8 percent. In the Chicago metro over the same period, the gap was 4.9 percent: 26,360 sellers against 25,125 buyers, a market Redfin classifies as balanced. Redfin, July 2026 data, published August 13, 2026.

FOUR THINGS TO DO BEFORE YOUR NEXT LISTING APPOINTMENT:

1 **Pull your own metro's buyer-to-seller ratio, not the national one.**

A seller who read the headline will ask about the buyer's market on the news. Show them Chicago's actual gap.

2 **Set buyer expectations to the local leverage, not the national leverage.**

Redfin's own senior economist, Asad Khan, describes the national trend as buyers gaining more options and more negotiating power. Locally, that leverage is far smaller.

3 **Reframe "balanced" for sellers as still moving, not stalled.**

A balanced market means priced right still sells. It does not mean priced wrong gets a pass.

4 **Check your own submarket, not just the metro number.**

A citywide 4.9 percent gap can hide neighborhoods running hotter or colder. Pull the same count for your own zip code before you set a number.

THE TAKEAWAY

BEFORE THE NEXT APPOINTMENT, PULL THE LOCAL BUYER-TO-SELLER RATIO. NOT THE NATIONAL ONE.

The headline says buyer's market. Chicago's own numbers say balanced. Bring the right one to the table.

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Keeping It Real Podcast